

There were better graphics and more powerful hardware, but there was still something missing in all of it.

Then came in the 32-bit era which led to the birth of consoles as we know them today. Also known as the 3D era, the 5th generation spanned the years from 1993 to 2001. This generation of consoles was going to change a lot of things, including making optical discs a standard, 2D paving way for 3D and new players turning into market leaders.

The first 5th generation console to be launched was the 3DO Interactive multiplayer manufactured by Panasonic, a new entrant in the game. Priced at \$700, it was expensive to say the least and even though it had a number of cutting edge technologies of the time including a CD-ROM (the simpler days right?), it was discontinued three years later in 1996. Sony, another new entrant, came out with its first console – the PlayStation. It came out as the clear winner among the rest of its generation and changed a lot of things



The major improvement in 5th generation over the 4th generation was the advent of CD-Rom technology which provided 10 times the space that conventional cartridges did.